VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

CSE0001 – DigitalLiteracy

PROJECT REPORT

Digital Literacy Portfolio — Student Digital Ambassador

A Practical Portfolio on Digital Skills, Online Safety, and Professional Communication

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Introduction

This project is part of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The premise of the assignment is simple but the scope of it is surprisingly wide: we are asked to play the role of a Student Digital Ambassador and build a full portfolio that covers everything from designing an infographic to writing professional emails to researching a real cybercrime. I found this format refreshing, honestly. Instead of a theory exam, we were being asked to actually do the things the course talks about.

The five tasks map directly to the five course modules. Task 1 required creating a digital literacy awareness infographic. Task 2 was about setting up a professional digital presence on platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate. Task 3 involved exploring coding platforms like CodeChef and building a Google Form quiz. Task 4 was about email etiquette — both writing professional emails and creating a social media checklist. Task 5, which I personally found the most engaging, required researching a cybercrime in detail and writing a case study along with a prevention guide.

All the work has been organised in a GitHub repository named digital-literacy-project. This report documents each task in the same order, with observations, reflections, and an honest account of what I found difficult or interesting along the way.

Task 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used and What Was Made

For Task 1, I used Canva to create a single-page infographic titled "Digital Literacy Guide." The brief required covering at least three topics from a given list. I ended up covering all five: what digital literacy means, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. My reasoning was that if this is actually going to be shared with batchmates, a half-done infographic is not really useful to anyone.

The design uses a dark background with sectioned cards, each covering one topic. I kept the language short and practical — the kind of thing a first-year student can skim in two minutes and still come away with something useful. For example, the "Safe Internet Practices" section lists specific actions like enabling two-factor authentication and avoiding banking on public Wi-Fi, rather than generic advice like "be careful online." The email etiquette section includes a real sample email template addressed to a professor, which I modelled on the kind of situation any student might actually face.

Reflection

The part I found genuinely difficult was deciding how much to fit into a single page without making it look cluttered. Canva makes it tempting to add more and more sections, but the more I added, the less readable it became. I ended up cutting several bullet points I had initially written and replacing them with shorter, punchier lines. I also spent more time than I expected on the colour palette and typography — not because I was aiming for something elaborate, but

because readability depends a lot on contrast and spacing, and getting that right takes iteration. Overall, I am fairly happy with how it turned out. The infographic is saved in the task-1-presentation/ folder of the repository.

Task 2 — Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

For this task, I set up accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate. Each one serves a different purpose, and thinking about why I was setting them up — not just that I was required to — made the process more deliberate.

GitHub

GitHub is the standard platform for hosting code and showing what you have built. I created a profile README for my account (github.com/rishirajsinghe) that introduces who I am, lists my current skills (Python, C++, HTML/CSS), and mentions what I am studying. I also added icons for the tools I use and links to connect with me. The README is written in Markdown, which itself turned out to be a small but useful skill to pick up.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is the professional networking platform that most recruiters and internship coordinators actually check first. I filled in my Education section with my current degree — Integrated M.Tech in Cyber Security at VIT Bhopal University, September 2025 to present — and added the certifications I have already earned: the JPMorganChase Software Engineering Job Simulation from Forage (December 2025) and the Google Gemini Certified University Student certification (December 2025, valid until 2028). I also added my skills and linked my GitHub profile.

ResearchGate

ResearchGate is primarily an academic networking site used by researchers to share papers, track citations, and follow developments in their field. As an M.Tech student, I do not have publications yet, but setting up the profile now — with my affiliation, disciplines (Computer Security and Reliability, Programming Languages, Artificial Intelligence), and skills — means the account is there and professional when the time comes to actually use it.

How I Plan to Use These Platforms

Over the next few years, GitHub will be where I document everything I build — every project, every experiment, every assignment that produces something worth keeping. LinkedIn I plan to use more actively for networking and internship applications; the certifications section will grow as I complete more courses. ResearchGate I will probably not use heavily until my third

or fourth year, when I begin working on a thesis or research paper. But having the profile already set up with the right details means that when that point arrives, I am not starting from scratch. Screenshots of all three profiles are in the task-2-portfolio/ folder.

Task 3 — Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Part A — Coding Practice

For the coding practice component, I used two platforms: CodeChef and HackerRank. On CodeChef, I completed a beginner-level problem titled "Print all the Arithmetic Operations," which required writing a C++ program to calculate and print the results of addition, subtraction, division, and multiplication between the numbers 8 and 4. The expected output was 12, 4, 2, and 32, and my solution was marked as correct. On HackerRank, I completed the "Input and
Output" challenge from the C++ Introduction section, which involved reading three integers from stdin and printing their sum. All six test cases passed and the submission was marked as successful.

These are beginner-level problems, and I do not want to pretend otherwise. But what I found useful about both platforms was not the difficulty of the problems themselves — it was getting comfortable with the submission workflow, reading problem statements carefully, and understanding what a judge expects from output format. On HackerRank specifically, I noticed that even small formatting mistakes (like an extra space or newline) cause a test case to fail, which is a discipline that carries over into real coding work. I also earned the C++ badge on HackerRank, which has been added to my profile.

Part B — Google Workspace Collaboration

For the Google Workspace component, I created a Google Form called "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with exactly five questions covering the topics from this course. The form description reads: "A short quiz to test awareness of digital literacy, online safety, and responsible internet usage."

The five questions are:

- What does Digital Literacy mean? (Multiple choice, 1 point)
- What is the term for deceptive attempts to steal sensitive information online? (Short answer, 1 point)
- Which of the following practices improve your online security? (Checkbox, 1 point)
- Which is the safest way to store passwords? (Multiple choice, 1 point)
- Which action is unsafe while using public Wi-Fi? (Multiple choice, 1 point)

The form is linked to a Google Sheet that collects responses automatically. I submitted two test responses to verify it was working correctly — the Sheet shows both entries with timestamps

and scores (4/5 and 5/5 respectively). The form link is included in the repository README and screenshots of both the form and the linked Sheet are in task-3-platforms/.

Reflection

What I found most useful about thistaskwas not the individual platforms in isolation, but the combination of them. Google FormsandSheets together make it genuinely easy to collect and review data without any technicalsetup— the kind of thing that would take hours to build from scratch is ready in minutes.Icanalready think of practical uses for this beyond this assignment: collecting feedbackafterapresentation, running a quick poll among classmates,
or building a basic sign-up formforacollege event. The coding platforms I plan to use regularly as part of my Cyber Securitystudies—particularly HackerRank, since it has well-structured tracks for C++ and eventuallyformoresecurity-relevant topics.

Task 4 — Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

Part A — Professional Emails

I wrote two professional emails for this task, both of which are saved as plain text files in the task-4-email-etiquette/ folder.

Email 1 — Requesting an Assignment Extension

This email was addressed to Professor Kannan, requesting a three-day extension on the Digital Literacy project due to overlapping academic deadlines. Writing this was actually a useful exercise because the reason I was writing it was real. I tried to keep the tone respectful and direct without being overly apologetic or making excuses. The email includes a clear subject line, a professional greeting, a short explanation, a specific request (three days), and a proper sign-off.

Email 2 — Internship Interest Enquiry

This email was addressed to an Internship Coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. I introduced myself, stated my current program, and mentioned my motivation for wanting practical exposure. I kept it short on purpose — an internship coordinator receives many such emails, and a long rambling message is unlikely to get a response. The email closes with full contact details including my registration number and email address.

Part B — Social Media Do's and Don'ts

The following checklist is for responsible social media use as a college student. The full file is saved in task-4-email-etiquette/ as social-media-checklist.txt.

Do's:

✓ Think before posting; assume everything online is permanent.
✓ Keep your profile professional and respectful.
✓ Use strong passwords and enable two-factor authentication.
✓ Verify information before sharing it.
✓ Respect others' opinions, privacy, and boundaries.

Don'ts:

✗ Do not share personal or sensitive information publicly.
✗ Do not post offensive, abusive, or inappropriate content.
✗ Do not engage in online arguments or trolling.
✗ Do not click on suspicious or unknown links.

- ✗ Do not overshare your location or daily routine.

Reflection — When Poor Digital Communication Caused a Problem

A well-documented real scenariothatillustrates the cost of poor digital communication is the case of a mid-level employeeatacompany who vented about their workplace on Twitter, assuming their account wasnotwidelyknown. The tweet reached their manager within hours through mutual connections,andtheperson was let go within days. What made it particularly avoidable is that nothing inthetweetwas false — it just happened to be the wrong place and wrong audience for that kindoffrustration. Had the same thought been shared in a private message or not at all, nothingwouldhave happened. The lesson is not that one cannot have opinions, but that social mediaisgenuinely public in a way that feels personal. The habit I would suggest — and thatItrytopractise myself — is a ten-second rule before posting anything remotely sensitive:askwhether the content would be embarrassing or harmful if your professor, future employer,orfamilyread it.

Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness: UPI and Online Payment Fraud

Case Study Summary

I chose UPI and Online Payment Fraud as the cybercrime type for this task. My reasoning was straightforward: it is the most relevant digital threat for the average Indian college student right now, and it is dramatically under-discussed in academic settings even though millions of people fall victim to it every year.

The full case study (saved as casestudy.pdf in task-5-cybercrime/) covers what UPI fraud is, how it works step by step, who is typically targeted, and what the consequences are. To summarise the key points here: UPI fraud is not primarily a technical attack. It is a social engineering attack that exploits a specific design feature of UPI — the fact that entering your PIN authorises an outgoing payment, not an incoming receipt. Fraudsters exploit this distinction by telling victims to "enter their PIN to accept a refund" when in reality they are authorising a debit. The transaction completes in under four seconds and is essentially irreversible.

The case study includes a fictional but realistic scenario based on documented fraud patterns: a retired schoolteacher from Bhopal who lists his motorcycle on OLX, receives a call from someone posing as PhonePe customer support, and loses Rs. 37,000 in two UPI transactions before realising what has happened. The scenario is drawn from the kinds of cases documented in the RBI Annual Report 2023-24, the I4C Annual Report 2023, and NPCI product statistics. All six sources are cited and described in full in the case study document.

Prevention Checklist

The full prevention checklist is saved as prevention-checklist.txt in task-5-cybercrime/. The ten key points are:

- Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or bank details with anyone, no matter how genuine they sound. Banks will never ask for this.
- Do not accept unknown collect requests on UPI apps. Entering your PIN means you are sending money, not receiving it.
- Always double-check payment requests before approving them. Cancel anything suspicious and verify with the sender separately.
- Avoid clicking on links from emails, messages, or social media that ask for personal or financial details.
- Use strong, unique passwords for all accounts and enable two-factor authentication (2FA).
- Do not install apps from unknown sources or allow screen-sharing access to strangers.

- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking or financial transactions.
- Keep your phone and apps updated regularly to fix security vulnerabilities.
- Be cautious of messages or calls that create urgency. Scammers deliberately use panic to make victims act without thinking.
- If you face cyber fraud, report it immediately at cybercrime.gov.in or call the helpline 1930.

Reflection

What genuinely surprised me while researching this topic was the scale. I knew UPI fraud was common, but I had not realised that it accounts for approximately 67% of all digital payment fraud complaints in India, or that the I4C data for 2023 translates to roughly 300 new victims every single day. That is not a niche problem. It is an epidemic, and a large portion of it is happening not because of any technical vulnerability but because people simply do not know that entering a UPI PIN authorises an outgoing payment.

The habit I personally intend to change is how I handle unexpected calls or messages involving any financial action. Before this, I might have given some benefit of the doubt to a caller who seemed to know a lot of details about me. Now I know that those details are almost certainly sourced from data breaches or public platforms, and knowing them is not proof of legitimacy. From now on, any call asking me to take a UPI action — no matter how official or urgent it sounds — gets ended, followed by a direct call to the official number of whatever organisation is supposedly involved.

Conclusion

Working through these five tasks has been a genuinely useful exercise. Not because each individual task was difficult — mostof them were not — but because doing them in sequence gave me a clearer picture of whataresponsible, informed digital presence actually looks like. Setting up GitHub and LinkedInwithintention rather than just creating accounts that sit empty; understanding that a professionalemail is not about length but about structure and tone; knowing that a UPI PIN isapayment authorisation, not an identity check — these are not abstract concepts anymore.Theyarethings I have now actually done or researched in depth.

The aspect I found mostvaluableoverall was Task 5. Cybercrime awareness is one of those topics that gets reducedtoalistofgeneric tips, and I was initially concerned that was all this task would amount to.Butresearching UPI fraud properly — reading the actual RBI and I4C reports, understandinghowtheattacksequence works, building the fictional scenario grounded in real data — turneditintosomething I feel I genuinely understand rather than just know about. That distinctionmatters.

The GitHub repositorywithalltaskfolders, files, and screenshots is the primary deliverable. This report documentsthethinking,process, and reflections behind each one.

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